



GAMERS' PARADISE.

With hugely popular gaming competitions like Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup rocking the circuit, it's one of the best of times for e-sports in the country.

The Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup, India's biggest and most revered Dota 2 tournament drew to a high-voltage action close, further reinforcing the popularity of the tournament that has become the highlight of the gaming industry in India since 2014 when it made its debut.

The Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup is a brilliant example of the frenzy that the gaming industry in India has been experiencing in the recent past. For instance, in the last couple of months, the streets in most of the metro cities of India were suddenly inundated with people scurrying in different directions – many of them ostensibly looking for something rather intently. While some may have mistaken them to be fitness enthusiasts going for their regular dose of exercise, those aware of the obsession knew they were all fans of Pokémon Go – the augmented reality-based mobile game that has become the latest fad in among youngsters. For those who tuned in late, the game is yet to be launched officially in India although people have been downloading it from unauthorised websites. This comes as no surprise because it may by now be safe to call India a nation fast becoming crazy about gaming.

Long before the Pokémon Go mania swept the country's youngsters off their feet, Indian gamers

had created a place for themselves in the gaming arena, perhaps, not as burly as their Korean or Taiwanese counterparts, nonetheless, a noteworthy one. According to a FICCI-KPMG report, the Indian gaming industry, which was worth \$171.66 million in 2010 grew at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 32.1 per cent through 2015 – not bad for a country that started off as a fledgling against the other well established countries in the gaming zone. By 2016, the Indian gaming industry is boasting of several new trends that have ensured a promising virtual renaissance.

WINDS OF CHANGE

The latest good news for the gaming industry in India is the advent of big gaming tournaments that promise to give passionate gamers their money's worth. Contests like the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup have now become a mecca for gamers. This year, the winning team of the Taiwan Excellence Gaming Cup walked away with a whopping Rs 2 lakh as cash prize while the second and third teams won Rs 80,000 and Rs 40,000 as prize money.

Yet, to understand the latest trends in the country's gaming industry, one may have to start